

IQBAL K I

PH.D. CANDIDATE IN QUANTITATIVE FINANCE

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Ph.D. candidate in Finance at Cochin University of Science and Technology specializing in quantitative finance, financial machine learning, and AI-driven portfolio management. My research examines the application of deep reinforcement learning and financial time-series modelling to portfolio optimization and asset allocation in emerging equity markets. I have published in Scopus-indexed Q1 and Q2 finance journals and have teaching experience in finance and accounting at undergraduate and postgraduate levels.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Quantitative Finance and Asset Management
- Financial Machine Learning
- Portfolio Optimization and Asset Allocation
- Deep Reinforcement Learning in Finance
- Financial Time-Series Modelling and Forecasting
- Financial Risk Management

EDUCATIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

Ph.D. in Finance	2022–Present
<i>Cochin University of Science and Technology</i>	
Research: Dynamic Portfolio Optimization with Deep Reinforcement Learning Agents	
Expected Thesis Submission: November 2026	
MBA – Finance & Operations	2017–2020
<i>Cochin University of Science and Technology</i>	
CGPA: 7.55/10	
Master of Commerce	2018–2021
<i>Indira Gandhi National Open University</i>	
Percentage: 62%	
Postgraduate Diploma in International Business Operations (PGDIBO)	2018–2019
<i>Indira Gandhi National Open University</i>	
Percentage: 63.17%	

ELIGIBILITY TESTS & FELLOWSHIPS

- **UGC NET & JRF – Commerce** (2020)
- **UGC NET – Management** (2019)

RESEARCH OUTPUTS

Publications

- Iqbal, K. I., & Ramachandran, R. (2026). Volatility Regime-Dependent Portfolio Optimization: Empirical Analysis of Deep Reinforcement Learning Agents. *Asia Pacific Financial Markets*, (Scopus–Q1)
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s10690-026-09629-8>
- Iqbal, K. I., & Ramachandran, R. (2025). Dynamic portfolio optimization with deep reinforcement learning: Empirical insights from Indian capital markets. *The Journal of Financial Data Science*, 8(1), 115–129. (Scopus–Q2)
<https://doi.org/10.3905/jfds.2025.1.210>

Manuscripts Under Review

- Iqbal, K. I., & Ramachandran, R. Deep Reinforcement Learning Portfolio Strategies Across Market Capitalization Segments: Evidence from an Emerging Market. [Major Revision]
- Iqbal, K. I., & Ramachandran, R. Deep Reinforcement Learning in Portfolio Management: A Comparative Study of Equity Market Agents. [Major Revision]

Working Papers

- Iqbal, K. I., & Ramachandran, R. Market Prediction Using K-Level Thinking Based Agent Modelling.

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATION

Data Scientist

2022–2023

Simplilearn – IBM

Focused on data science using Python, machine learning models, and complex data visualisation structures.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Iqbal, K. I., & Ramachandran, R. (2024). *Artificial intelligence in stock market forecasting: Exploring the long short-term memory model for stock prediction*. Paper presented at the India Management Research Conference (**IMRC 2024**), Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad, India.
- Iqbal, K. I., & Ramachandran, R. (2023). *ESG consideration in investment decision: Investigating its impact on investment returns*. Paper presented at the 2nd International Management Conference on Industry 5.0, VIT Bhopal University, India.

WORKSHOPS & FACULTY DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMS

- International Faculty Development Program on Financial Analytics Using Python
Alliance University (December 2023)
- Workshop on Investment Analysis and Portfolio Management Using Real-Time Data
Christ (Deemed to be University), Bangalore (June 2023)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Assistant Professor (BBA)

June 2021 – May 2022

Al Ameen College, Edathala

Courses handled: Financial Management, Cost and Management Accounting, Financial Accounting

Assistant Professor (MBA)

February 2021 – April 2021

Kannur University Centre, Nileshtar

Courses handled: Financial Management, International Financial Management, Operations Research

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- Teaching Assistance - Security Analysis and Portfolio Management, Financial Management & Financial Accounting (2025 - 26)
- Organizing Committee Member – International Doctoral Colloquium, School of Management Studies, Cochin University of Science and Technology (May 2025)
- Organizing Committee Member – International Conference & Doctoral Colloquium, School of Management Studies, Cochin University of Science and Technology (May 2026)
- Coordinator, Placement Cell for Research Students, School of Management Studies, CUSAT (2024–2025)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- Member, Indian Society for Training and Development (ISTD)

RESEARCH & TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python, R
- **Machine Learning:** Deep Learning, Reinforcement Learning, LSTM, supervised learning
- **Quantitative Finance:** Portfolio Optimization, Asset Allocation, Financial Time-Series Analysis, Volatility Modelling
- **Econometrics:** Financial Modelling, Time-Series Econometrics, GARCH/DCC-GARCH, Structural Break Analysis
- **Visualization Tools:** Power BI, Tableau

REFERENCES

1. Dr. Remya Ramachandran

PhD Supervisor

Assistant Professor, School of Management Studies

Cochin University of Science and Technology

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2. Dr. Sam Thomas

Professor and Director, School of Management Studies

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3. Dr. Madhu S. Nair

Professor, Department of Computer Science

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